

TOPIC 5: BALL GAMES – HOCKEY (PART 1)

1. Nature of the Game

Hockey (field hockey) is a team game played with sticks and a ball on a rectangular field with a goal at each end. Two teams try to hit the ball into the opponent's goal. It demands skill, teamwork, fitness and fair play.

2. Basic Skills and Techniques

- Grip and stance
- Dribbling (moving with the ball under control)
- Passing and receiving
- Hitting and pushing the ball
- Tackling (safely dispossessing an opponent)
- Shooting at goal

Practise each skill slowly, then under pressure and in small games.

3. Rules and Safety Regulations

Play the ball with the flat side of the stick; no dangerous swinging; no body contact that endangers others; respect the umpire's decisions. Wear shin guards and suitable footwear; check the pitch for hazards; warm up before play.

4. Summary

Hockey is a skilled team sport. Master basic techniques and obey rules and safety guidelines for enjoyable, safe play.

End of Topic 5